The Goblat

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BDT 2015 · Malmö · Featuring Ollie

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale



BDT 2018 – Hursty takes the Goblat

In Memory 48 we spent some time remembering Picko, RIP. Tragically we have one other departed friend, Ollie Gobat, RIP.

The sheer brutality of Ollie's death hit us hard and BDT 2014, which took place just days after his passing, will always be remembered as a tour when everyone rallied together in a manner of which Ollie would have been so proud.



The Goblat!

Ollie first toured on BDT 2011, as a replacement for my good self as it happens as my eldest Patrick was due not long after that tour. Based in St Lucia at the time, he joined the group despite only knowing a handful of the Dogs but with a reputation as an excellent sportsman and a single figure handicapper.

Accordingly, there was much anticipation when Ollie's turn came on the first tee in Round I, a par 4 on the Jim McLean Signature Course. Eyebrows were raised when Ollie casually chucked his ball onto the tee bed and sauntered up to play his shot – no tee required for a three iron off the deck! Such confidence had never before been seen on a BDT and certainly not for an opening gambit!

Soon everyone was having a good old Barry Chuckle as Ollie proceeded to smash not one, but two Pro V1s into the water left!

Despite those inauspicious beginnings, Ollie actually went on to win his debut tour, although I have to say that this did not come as much of a surprise to me knowing just how competitive he was. He also took home the Great Dane. We spoke after the tour and he was effusive about what a great set of lads were on the trip and how much he enjoyed himself.

Ollie rejoined us on BDT 2012 and was lying in second place after Round II; privately, he was adamant he would have chased down the Monkey in Round III had it not been rained off! He missed BDT 2013 due to attending brother Adam's 40th birthday, but was all set to join us in Villa el Canine for BDT 2014 when tragedy struck.

I met Ollie at Leeds University when we started there together in 1995 and he undoubtedly changed my life, having a profound effect on me and many others in all sorts of ways. These were the words I wrote at the time of his death:


PADDY

"Ollie had an unparalleled sense of humour, a razor-sharp wit (I am sure Purlo will attest to this, as he was often on the receiving end!) and an entertaining irreverence for life. Despite the jovial-never-take-life-seriously outward appearance he portrayed, he was a deep thinker with a philosophy degree. He loved music, particularly with a Caribbean flavour and especially Byron Lee & The Dragonaires.

A huge Chelsea fan, he was a natural sportsman at everything he turned his hand to, as evidenced by the fact that approaching his 40th birthday he was in contention to play squash for St Lucia in the Commonwealth Games. He was an incredibly strong individual in mind and body, never better demonstrated than by his determined recovery from childhood leukaemia, while most of his contemporaries unfortunately succumbed to the illness.

He was a very successful businessman. He was just a hugely impressive man, never more so than when you introduced him to others, who would immediately feel at ease in his company. To be writing about Ollie in the past tense simply doesn't feel right at all and it will take us all some considerable time to come to terms with his death and particularly the manner of it."

12 years later it still doesn't feel right to be talking about Ollie in the past tense and it never will.

The year after Ollie's passing, in Malmö on BDT 2015, we introduced the Goblat trophy as a permanent reminder of his presence. The Goblat is awarded in Ollie's memory by a majority vote on the final day of the tour and it goes to the person who has shown the greatest all round form and best represented the BDT spirit.

We would all like to win the Individual and, even more so, Big Dogs Ryder Cup and the latter provides the focal point for the trip so it will always be top of the tour memory list. But I feel we all know that the Goblat is the most important trophy on the BDT, for it encapsulates the very essence of the tour: friendship.

We first presented the Goblat on BDT 2015 in Malmö, the year after Ollie's untimely passing. We were delighted to welcome Rufus on that trip and subsequently Adam for his first tour on BDT 2017 to Mallorca and long may they both continue to join us on future tours.

There have been 11 winners of the trophy since then, as shown below:


BDT 2015 – Jules


BDT 2016 – Rick


BDT 2017 – Marshy



BDT 2019 – Tully



BDT 2020 – BT



BDT 2021 – Langers



BDT 2022 – Ash



BDT 2023 – Hulmey



BDT 2024 – Little



BDT 2025 – Buzz

As always, we will hold a minute's silence for Ollie and for Picko on the first tee of Round I and, as defending Goblat-holder, Big Buzz will have the great privilege of hitting the Ollie ball as the first shot of the tour.

A short story that surely best sums up Ollie comes from BT, who recalls the time in Thailand at his wedding bash when Ollie said he was pretty good on the guitar. Hursty and Ravo smelt BS and called him out on it, grabbing a guitar and putting him on the spot. By all accounts he then belted out Imagine perfectly!

I'm certain that on this, the 25th anniversary trip, the Goblat will be more fiercely contested than ever before and come the end of the tour may the most deserving Dog take it home.

A few photos of Ollie are below along with a slideshow from his memorial. May he Rest In Peace.

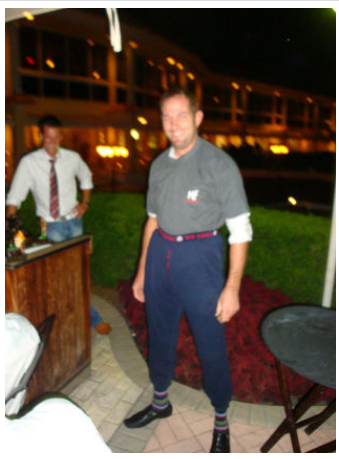








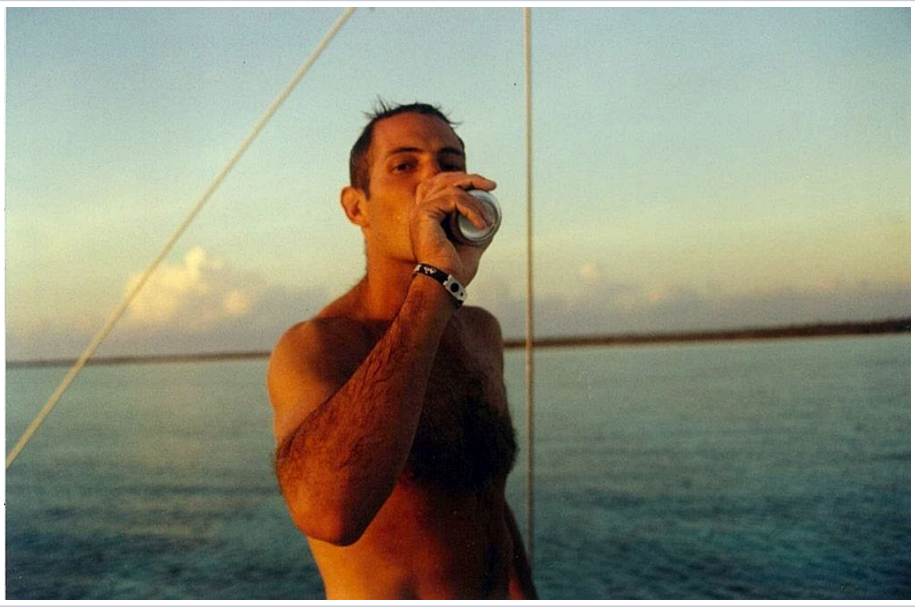


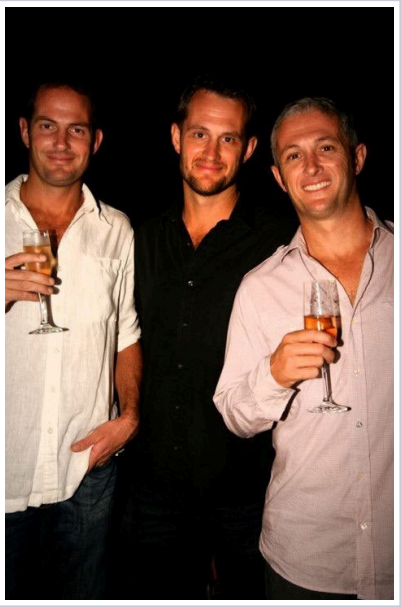
















▶ **Watch:** A tribute to Ollie

SINCE SCOTTSDALE

Paddy won the Goblat in Scottsdale, its 12th winner.